BEAT FROM NOTHING

Pacing guide · 4 days (2 learning / 1 work / 1 present)

PACING

Teacher

Four class periods of about 53 minutes: two learning days, one work day, one presenting day. Each day's full plan, minute by minute, is on pages 6–7.

DAY	FOCUS AND GOAL	MINUTE BLOCKS	SHOW
DAY 1 Learning	**Name the kit, hear the loop** Students can name every part of the kit, define a loop, and count beats and measures by ear. Nothing is built in Logic yet.	0–5 min · Hook 5–17 min · Parts of the drum set 17–35 min · Intro deck: loops 35–50 min · Drumbeat listening 50–53 min · Exit check	Intro deck slides 1–8
DAY 2 Learning + first time in Logic	**Copy a famous pattern** Every student can create a pattern region, cycle a measure, add and duplicate tracks, change an instrument and set the tempo, and has one famous pattern checked off. The project launches at the end of class.	0–5 min · Vocabulary review 5–15 min · First pattern region 15–23 min · Logic techniques 23–38 min · Copy a famous pattern 38–53 min · Launch the project	Intro deck slides 9–15
DAY 3 Work day: build and mix	**A, B, AABA, mix, submit** Project submitted by the end of class: 16 measures in AABA, every track's volume set, two tracks panned.	0–18 min · A section 18–30 min · B section 30–37 min · Arrange AABA 37–48 min · Mixing focus 48–53 min · Export and submit	Project sheet + checklist
DAY 4 Presenting	**Share and give feedback** Every student plays their beat, hears feedback, and gives specific feedback to two classmates.	0–5 min · Feedback questions 5–50 min · Presentations 50–53 min · Close	Rubric

NEED A FIFTH DAY?

Split Day 3: build the A section on one day; the B section, AABA and mix on the next. That is the 5-day version I have taught. Presentations then move to Day 5.

AABA AT A GLANCE



4 measures each · 16 measures · B = A with one change

STUDENT PAGES BY DAY ·

Day 1	Day 1 post (p. 10), Parts of the Drum Set (p. 11), Drumbeat Listening (p. 12), Vocabulary (p. 16)
Day 2	Famous Drum Patterns (p. 13), Project Sheet (pp. 14–15), Rubric (p. 18)
Day 3	Project Sheet steps 4–7, Submission Checklist (p. 17)
Day 4	Rubric for self-score and teacher score (p. 18)

PREVIEW

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PROJECT SHEET

Digital Music Production 1 · Unit 1 · Structured Project · Drum Machine Designer

OVERVIEW ·

You're going to build an original drum beat from nothing: no loops, no pre-made grooves. Starting with the three building blocks of a drum kit (kick, snare, hi-hat), you'll explore rhythm, pattern, and what makes a beat feel right. You'll also analyze a famous drum beat to understand how real producers think about groove. By the end, you'll have made something entirely your own, and you'll understand exactly why it works.

GOALS ·

- Identify the kick, snare, and hi-hat by name, sound, and function
- Build an original drum beat using Logic Pro's Drum Machine Designer
- Understand how volume and panning affect the feel of a mix
- Experience the creative process of building something musical from scratch

REQUIREMENTS ·

- [ ] Built entirely in Drum Machine Designer: no Apple Loops
- [ ] Must include: kick drum, snare drum, closed hi-hat, and at least one additional element (open hi-hat, clap, rim, shaker, etc.)
- [ ] Minimum 16 measures, structured in AABA form (A = main beat, B = variation, A = main beat returns)
- [ ] Volume adjusted thoughtfully on all tracks: nothing at default
- [ ] Panning applied intentionally to at least 2 tracks
- [ ] Project named correctly: Your Name – Beat From Nothing
- [ ] Exported as MP3 and .zip (compressed .logicx file) and submitted to your class page before presenting

YOUR BEAT'S SHAPE



4 measures each · 16 measures · B = A with one change

KEY VOCABULARY

14 terms on page 16: kick, snare, hi-hat, loop, beat, measure, step sequencer, subdivision, tempo, pattern region, cycle, AABA, volume, panning.

PREVIEW

BEAT FROM NOTHING

Drumbeat listening examples

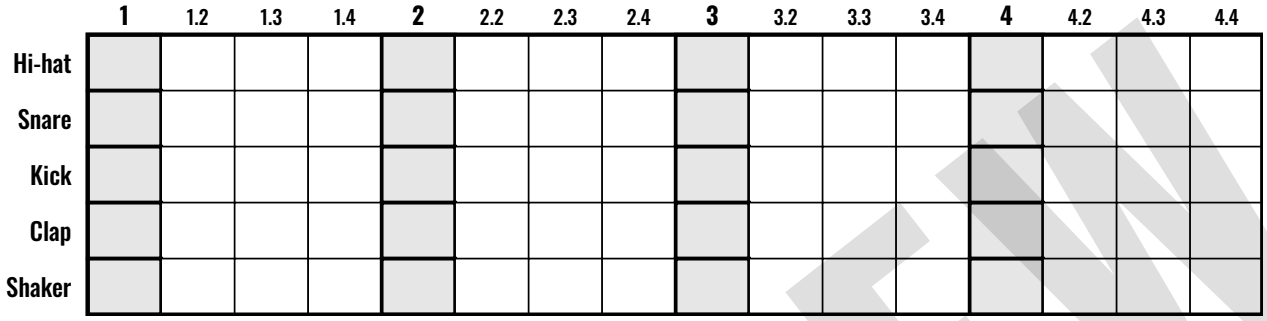
STUDENT

Day 1 · answers p. 19

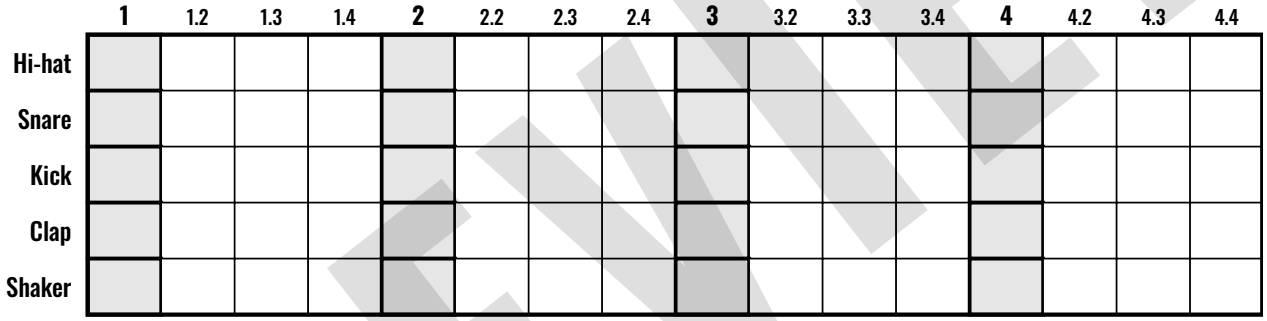
Name _____ Date _____

Your teacher plays three drum beats. Each grid is one measure: 16 squares, four beats (the shaded squares are the beats: 1, 2, 3, 4). Put an X where you hear each sound. Count. Listen. Discuss.

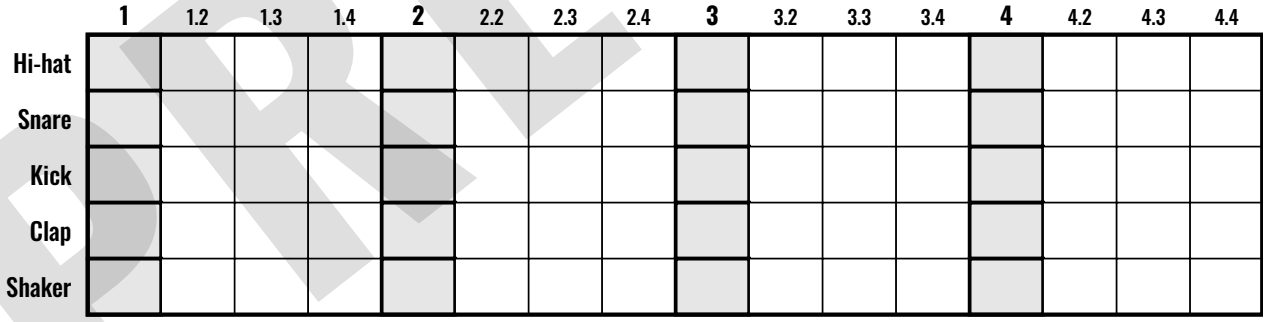
EXAMPLE 1



EXAMPLE 2



EXAMPLE 3



Where does the snare land in all three? _____

Which example feels busiest? Why? _____

What is the hi-hat doing in Example 3? _____

PREVIEW

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BEAT FROM NOTHING

RUBRIC

Rubric

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

Score each category from 2 to 5. Score yourself first, then your teacher scores.

Category	2	3	4	5	Self	Teacher
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Beat is basic with little creative decision-making. Sounds like the default example.	Beat is functional but predictable. B section exists but contrast is minimal.	Beat shows clear creative choices. B section is noticeably different from A.	Beat has a distinct feel and personality. B section creates meaningful contrast. Goes beyond the obvious.		
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Basic use of the step sequencer with significant errors or workflow confusion.	Step sequencer used but some elements seem randomly placed. Some workflow confusion.	Step sequencer used correctly. All required elements present and placed with intention.	Drum Machine Designer used confidently. Pattern regions, 64-step, or note repeat used with control.		
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	No clear structure. Beat does not repeat in a musical way.	Structure attempted but A and B sections are not clearly differentiated.	AABA structure is present and mostly clear. Beat feels mostly locked in rhythmically.	AABA structure is clear and musically satisfying. Beat locks in and feels complete.		
VOLUME & BALANCE	No meaningful volume or panning adjustments. Everything at default levels.	Some volume adjustments made but mix feels unbalanced. Little or no panning applied.	Most elements are balanced. Volume and panning adjustments are evident and mostly appropriate.	All elements are balanced with intention. Each drum sound has its own space. Panning adds width without distraction.		
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Project not submitted or not presented.	Project submitted late or named incorrectly. Presentation made with minimal engagement.	Project named correctly and submitted. Presentation made. Feedback questions posted.	Project correctly named, submitted on time. Confident presentation. Three thoughtful feedback questions posted.		
				TOTAL	**/ 25**	**/ 25**

ONE THING I'M PROUD OF

TEACHER COMMENTS

PREVIEW

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